Portfolio companion

A user manual for the A2UI finance showcase — an assistant that answers portfolio questions by composing interface, not paragraphs.

Audience	Anyone seeing the application for the first time
Built by	Somnio Software, with Google
Build shown	`local+5cb9a40`
Screens captured	22 September 2026
Portfolio data	**Simulated.** No live prices, no broker, no money

1 What this application is

Ask a normal question about a portfolio — *“how is my money split up?”*, *“what moved today?”*, *“which lots would I sell?”* — and most assistants answer with a paragraph. You then have to trust a number you cannot inspect, sitting in a sentence you cannot click.

This application answers differently. It replies with **the actual interface**: a donut of your allocation, a table of your lots, a breakdown of what moved. The same components the rest of the app is built from, assembled on the spot in response to what you asked.

That is what “A2UI” means here — an agent that speaks in user interface. It is a working reference application, open source under Apache 2.0, and the four screens in this manual are the whole product.

> **Two things worth knowing before the walkthrough**
>
> **The assistant chooses, it does not invent.** It picks from a fixed, published set of components and fills them in. It cannot draw something the app was not built to draw, which is why nothing ever arrives looking broken or improvised.
>
> **The assistant never does the arithmetic.** Every figure on screen is calculated by the system and handed to the assistant already written out. The assistant decides *what to show you*; the numbers come from code that is tested. A language model is not permitted to add anything up.

2 Read this first: the portfolio is simulated

Every figure in this application is generated from a fixed, repeatable recipe. It is a convincing portfolio and it is not a real one.

What you see	What it actually is
Prices and market moves	Simulated. There is no market-data feed and no pricing licence behind this app.
Balances, holdings, tax lots	Simulated. Generated from a fixed seed, so the demo shows the same figures every time.
Activity — dividends, deposits, sales	Simulated, and reset for each session.
Buying or selling anything	Does not exist. There is no broker connection and no way to move money.
The assistant, the components, the app itself	**Real**, and deployed. What you are evaluating is the interaction, and that part is genuine.

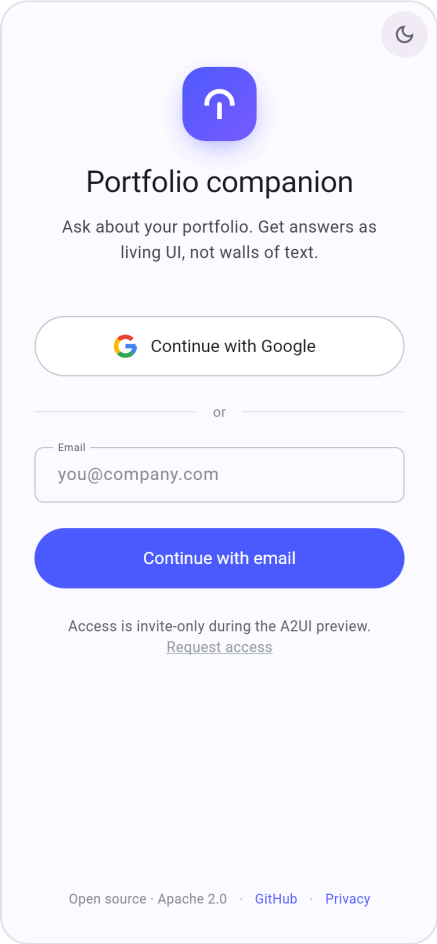
The application says so on screen rather than leaving it to a footnote. A **Simulated portfolio** badge sits beside your name on Home, the Activity list is headed *“Simulated activity — resets each session”*, and the assistant carries a **Simulated** badge of its own.

> **Not financial advice**
>
> Nothing this application displays is a recommendation, and nothing in it can be acted on. It is a demonstration of how an assistant and an interface can work together, using invented money.

The choice is deliberate. A fixed portfolio means the demo behaves identically for every viewer, and it means a screenshot in this manual can be checked against the running app rather than aged out by a market that moved overnight.

PART TWO · WALKTHROUGH

3 Signing in



Two ways in, and the app is honest about which one is available to you.

Continue with Google is the normal route for a hosted environment.

Continue with email takes an address and lets you straight through. This is the path to use for a local or demo build, where there is no Google project configured; the app says so rather than showing a button that cannot work.

Access is invite-only during the preview, and **Request access** under the buttons is how somebody without an account asks for one.

Each portfolio belongs to the address that signed in, so two people in the same demo do not see each other's figures.

What you land in

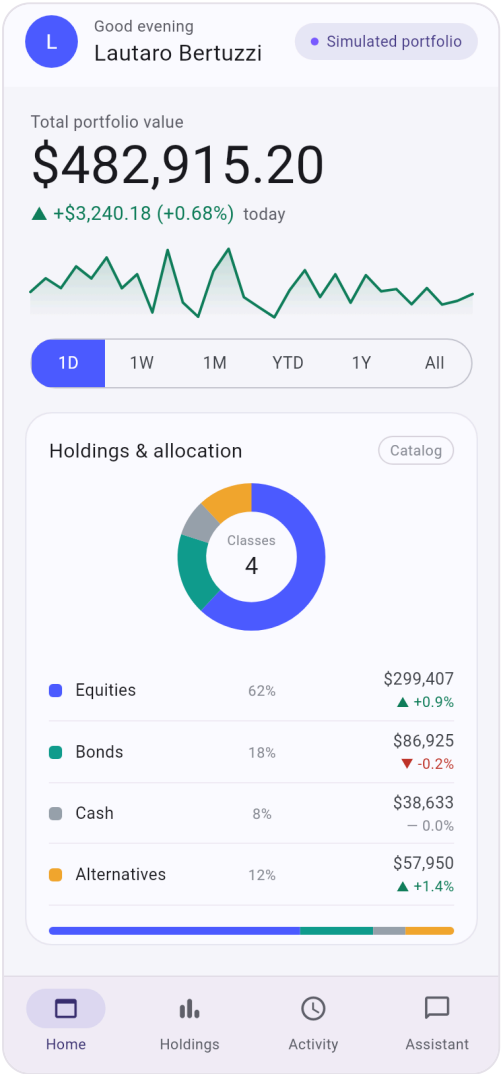
After signing in you are inside a four-tab application. The bar at the bottom is the whole of the navigation.

Tab	The question it answers
Home	How am I doing right now, in one screen?
Holdings	What exactly do I own, and how is it grouped?
Activity	What has happened to this portfolio lately?
Assistant	Anything you can put into words.

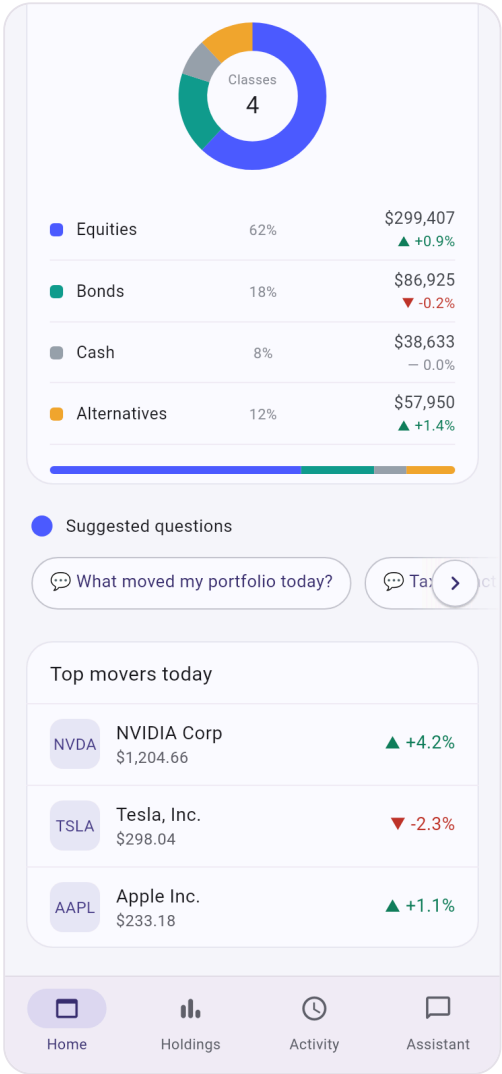
A round moon or sun button in the corner of the first screen switches the whole app between light and dark. Every screen in this manual is shown in light mode; the dark one is the same layout with a palette the designers measured separately.

4 Home — the daily glance

Home is built to be read in about five seconds and then left alone. It opens on the one figure most people want, and everything under it is context for that figure.



The top of Home. Note the **Simulated portfolio** badge beside the name.



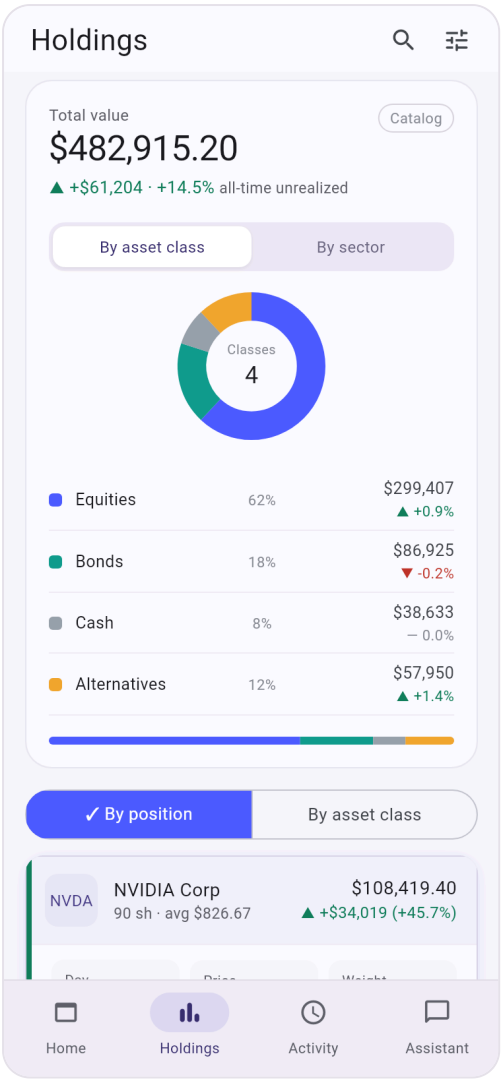
Further down: suggested questions, then the day's biggest movers.

Element	What it tells you
Total portfolio value	Everything, added up, with today's change underneath in green or red.
The sparkline	The shape of the period, drawn small. It is a picture of the trend, not a chart to read values off.
1D · 1W · 1M · YTD · 1Y · All	The period the line and the change above it describe. Tap one and both update.
Holdings & allocation	Your money split by asset class — equities, bonds, cash, alternatives — as a ring, then as a list with each class's value and move.
Suggested questions	Shortcuts. Tapping one carries that question into the Assistant with it, so you never have to start from a blank field.
Top movers today	The handful of positions responsible for most of the day's change.

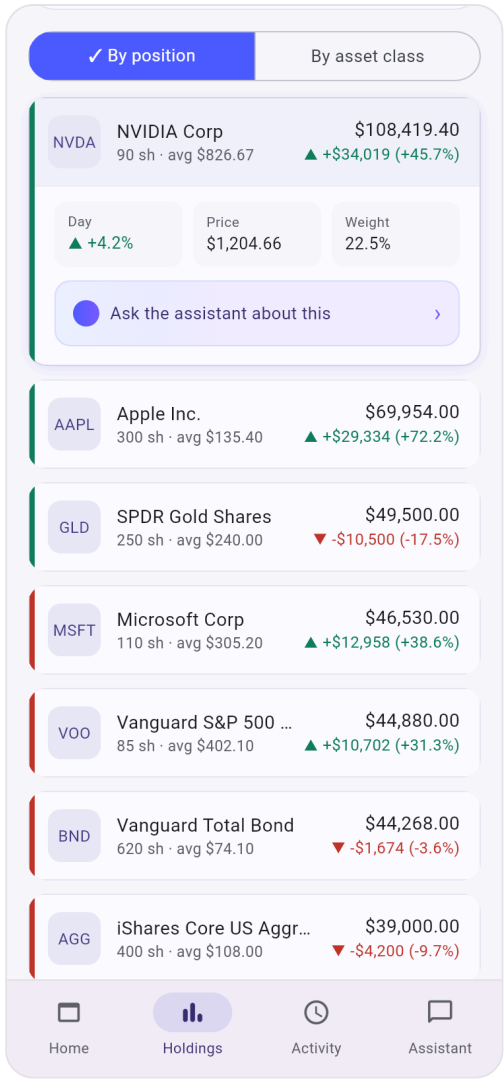
The colour language is consistent everywhere in the app and worth learning once: green with an up triangle is a gain, red with a down triangle is a loss, and a grey dash means nothing moved.

5 Holdings — what you actually own

Home tells you how much. Holdings tells you what, and lets you look at the same money two different ways without leaving the screen.



The top half groups the portfolio. The toggle above the ring switches between asset class and sector.



The bottom half lists positions. Tapping one opens it in place.

Reading a position

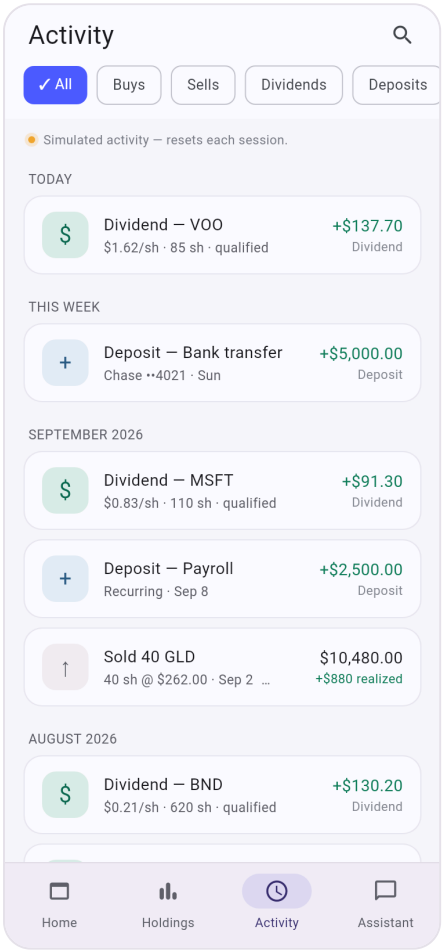
Each row carries the ticker, the name, how many shares and what you paid on average, then the position's value today and what it has gained or lost since you bought it. The coloured edge down the left repeats that in a glance.

Tap a row and it expands with three more facts — the move today, the current price, and how much of the whole portfolio this one position represents. That last number, **Weight**, is the one people usually came looking for.

Inside the expanded row is **Ask the assistant about this**. It hands the position straight to the Assistant tab, already framed as a question, so you do not have to describe what you are looking at.

Control	What it does
By asset class / By sector	Regroups the ring and the breakdown above. Same money, two ways of cutting it.
By position / By asset class	Regroups the list below into individual holdings or into buckets.
Search	Finds a holding by ticker or name.
Filter	Narrows the list down to a subset of what you own.

6 Activity — what has been happening



Activity is the portfolio's diary: every dividend, deposit, purchase and sale, newest first.

Entries are grouped under plain headings — **Today**, **This week**, then by month — rather than a wall of dates, so the recent past reads at a glance.

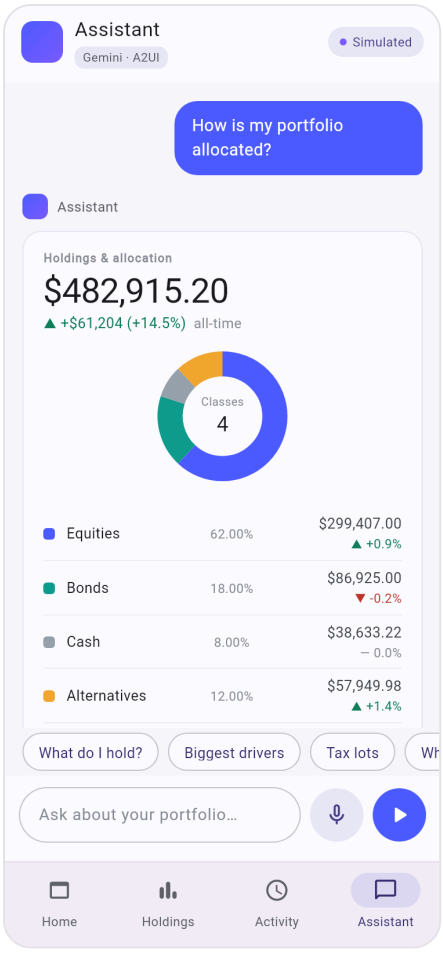
Each entry says what happened, and the second line carries the detail that makes it checkable: the rate per share and how many shares for a dividend, the account and day for a deposit, the price and the gain realised for a sale.

The chips across the top filter the list: **All**, **Buys**, **Sells**, **Dividends**, **Deposits**. The magnifying glass searches it.

The amber line under the chips is the app being straight with you: *"Simulated activity — resets each session."* Nothing here happened, and nothing you do here can make it happen.

7 The Assistant — the point of the whole thing

The first three tabs are a good portfolio app. The fourth is the reason this one exists.



One question, answered with a component — not a paragraph describing one.

How to use it

Type a question into the field at the bottom and send it. Or tap the **microphone** and dictate it — and if the browser will not allow dictation, the app tells you so instead of quietly doing nothing.

You can also arrive here from elsewhere: a suggested question on Home, or **Ask the assistant about this** on a position, both open this tab with the question already written.

What comes back

Your question appears as a bubble. Under it, the assistant replies with a **live component** — in the example, the allocation ring and breakdown, the same one Home and Holdings use, filled with this portfolio's figures.

Underneath sit **follow-up chips**. They are the assistant offering the obvious next questions, so a conversation can be three taps rather than three sentences.

Things to try in a demo

- *"How is my portfolio allocated?"* — returns the allocation component.
- *"What do I hold?"* — returns the positions.
- *"What are my biggest drivers?"* — returns a breakdown of what moved the total.
- *"Show me my tax lots."* — returns the lot-level table.

The two badges in the header are worth pointing at during a demo. **Gemini · A2UI** names what is answering: Google's Gemini model, speaking through the A2UI protocol. **Simulated** repeats that the figures underneath are invented.

> ### What the assistant is not doing
>
> It is not writing HTML, and it is not designing a layout on the fly. It selects a component from a published catalog and fills in the options that component declares. Anything outside that catalog it simply cannot produce — which is why an answer never arrives malformed.
>
> It is also not calculating. Every currency figure and every percentage in the component above was worked out by the system and handed over already formatted. The assistant copies them; it is not allowed to compute one.

This is an early preview of a genuinely new interaction, and it behaves like one. An answer takes a few seconds to assemble, and a question far outside the portfolio's subject will be answered less confidently than one inside it. Stay near the four topics above and the demo is reliable.

PART THREE · WHY IT MATTERS

8 The value of the idea

Set the portfolio aside for a moment. What is being demonstrated is a way of building software where the assistant and the interface are the same thing.

What changes	Why it is worth something
An answer you can use	A paragraph about your allocation is something to read. A live allocation component is something to tap, sort, and carry on from. The answer is a starting point rather than an endpoint.
An answer you can check	Because the figures come from the system and not from the model, the number in the assistant's reply is the same number the Holdings tab shows. There are not two versions of the truth.
An answer that cannot be malformed	The assistant can only compose from a catalog of components that already exist and are already tested. The failure mode where a model invents a broken layout is removed by construction, not by careful prompting.
A product that grows in one place	A new chart is added once, on the server, and the assistant can use it immediately. There is no second piece of work on each client to catch up.
An interface that fits the question	Nobody has to predict, at design time, which of a hundred questions deserves its own screen. The screen is assembled when the question is asked.

For the technically curious, the app carries its own proof of this: a built-in gallery, reachable from the **Catalog** button on the allocation card, listing every component this build can render. That list is generated from the server's own registry — it is the contract the assistant chooses from, shown live.

9 Limits, plainly stated

A demo is more persuasive when it says what it does not do.

- **No live market data.** No pricing feed, no market-data licence. Prices are generated.
- **No broker, no orders, no transfers.** There is no path from this application to anybody's money, and there is not going to be one here.
- **No advice.** Nothing on screen is a recommendation to do anything.
- **Not a real account.** Signing in creates a demo portfolio for that address. It is not connected to anything you own.

- **An early preview.** The assistant is the newest part of the product and the part still moving fastest. Treat what it returns as a demonstration of the interaction, not as a finished feature set.

Quick reference

If you want to…	Go to
See the total and today's move	Home, at the top
Change the period of the chart	Home — the 1D / 1W / 1M / YTD / 1Y / All row
See the split by asset class or sector	Holdings — the toggle above the ring
Find one holding	Holdings — the magnifying glass
See a position's weight in the portfolio	Holdings — tap the row to expand it
Check a dividend or a deposit	Activity — filter to Dividends or Deposits
Ask anything at all	Assistant — type it, or tap the microphone
Ask about the holding you are looking at	Holdings — *Ask the assistant about this*
Switch to dark mode	The moon button on the sign-in screen

Portfolio companion — user manual · Somnio Software with Google · Screens captured from build `local+5cb9a40` on 22 September 2026 · Open source, Apache 2.0 · The portfolio shown throughout is simulated.